

Lessons

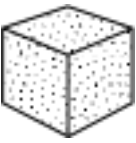
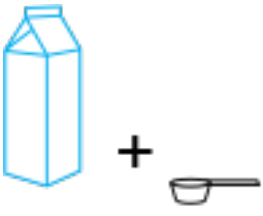
Basic Metric Units

The most commonly used measurement system is the **metric system**. The standard metric unit of length is the meter. Some of the most common metric units of length are shown here with similar customary units.

Some common metric units of weight and capacity are shown below. The standard metric unit of weight is the **gram**. The standard metric unit of capacity is the **liter**. Remember, capacity measures liquid or granular amounts.

Metric Units of Length	
1 millimeter (mm) $\frac{1}{16}$ inch (in) to scale	1 meter (m) 1 yard (yd) to scale
1 centimeter (cm) 1 inch (in) to scale	1 kilometer (km) 1 mile (mi) to scale

Metric Units of Weight	
1 milligram (mg) about the weight of a grain of salt	
1 gram (g) about the weight of a pencil eraser	
1 kilogram (kg) a little over 2 pounds	

Metric Units of Capacity	
1 milliliter (ml) about the size of a sugar cube	
1 liter a little more than 1 quart	 1 qt $\frac{1}{4}$ c

Key Terms

-  **metric units of measurement**
-  **rate**
-  **unit multiplier**

Skill Tip

One advantage to metric units is that they differ from each other by one power of 10. When converting between metric units, simply multiply or divide by the correct power of 10. This can be done by moving the decimal point in the number.

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Lesson 2: The Metric System

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